



1967/68, and the one after that in 1977/78. This last tour of 1977/78 was when they suddenly noticed the following for Indian cricket, as thousands of Indians living in Australia came to watch the Test series. Since then, it has been every four years for India, as it is with their oldest rival, the Mother Country. **However, in the last six years, this is India's third tour to Australia, and next year the Indians will be touring for a white-ball series.**

With all this, one would expect some sense of gratitude. However, the BCCI bashing continues for no reason. Stories are fabricated without any basis in truth, and if proven wrong, there is no acknowledgement. Thankfully, the current players of both teams accept that they have to play on the surfaces given to them, so while there might be murmurs in the change room and a nudge-nudge to their favourite media person, there is nothing in public. Look at the way Ben Stokes accepted the pitches in India and even recently in Pakistan, saying that his team was outplayed and needed to learn to play on such surfaces.

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Adaptability: "Have you ever heard an Indian player or a former player complain about the trampoline bounce of some surfaces or the grazing area for cattle masquerading as a Test match pitch in these countries?," asks the author.

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former player complain about the trampoline bounce of some surfaces or the grazing area for cattle masquerading as a Test match pitch in these countries? Never, as we accept that playing and winning overseas is a challenge since the conditions are different from home. Surprisingly, even the whingeing British media did not have anything to say about the surfaces in the final two Test matches, which they lost in Pakistan, once again strengthening the belief that when it comes to the BCCI and Indian cricket, the knives have to be out. **Or maybe it is easier to be condescending to a country that does not have the clout that the BCCI has.**

Remember the words, guys. Yes, remember the words and fling them back when the whingeing starts the next time they are in India.



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